

Document 1: Comprehensive Return, Refund, and Exchange Policy

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1. Standard Return Window and Eligibility Criteria

TechMart is committed to ensuring absolute customer satisfaction. If you are not entirely satisfied with your purchase, we offer a comprehensive return framework. Customers are eligible to initiate a return request within **15 calendar days** from the exact date of delivery. The delivery date is strictly determined by the time stamp provided by our integrated third-party logistics partners showing a "Delivered" status.

To qualify for a standard return, items must fulfill the following mandatory criteria:

- The product must be completely unused, unaltered, and in the exact same condition that you received it.
- The item must be housed in its original, undamaged manufacturer packaging, including all retail boxes, internal cardboard structures, and protective styrofoam.
- All original serial numbers, Universal Product Codes (UPCs), price tags, brand labels, and authenticity certificates must be intact and securely attached to the product.
- The product must be returned complete with all accompanying accessories, peripherals, instruction manuals, registration cards, and any free promotional items or bundled gifts that were included in the original transaction.

Note: TechMart reserves the absolute right to reject any return request if the product exhibits signs of unauthorized usage, physical modification, or missing components during our centralized warehouse audit.

2. Non-Returnable and Restricted Product Categories

To maintain strict standards of health, hygiene, data security, and operational safety, certain categories of merchandise sold on TechMart are completely excluded from our standard 15-day return policy. The following items cannot be returned, refunded, or exchanged under any circumstances once the delivery has been successfully executed:

- **Personal Hygiene and Grooming Appliances:** Electric trimmers, shavers, epilators, hair straighteners, toothbrushes, and skin care devices whose outer hygienic seals have been broken or tampered with.
- **Wearables and Personal Apparel:** Innerwear, socks, swimwear, and specific athleisure items that are explicitly designated as non-returnable on the individual product detail page.
- **Digital Goods and Software Licenses:** Downloadable software applications, video games, operating system keys, subscription activation codes, or digital gift cards once the cryptographic key or download link has been exposed or accessed.
- **Consumables and Perishables:** Open packaged items, nutritional supplements, fitness powders, batteries, and cleaning chemicals.

- **Customized and Personalized Merchandise:** Any hardware, laptop, or gadget that has undergone custom factory engraving, bespoke specification modifications, or personalized configurations requested by the customer during the checkout process.

3. Financial Refund Protocols and Processing Timeframes

Once a returned item is successfully collected by our logistics network and routed back to our fulfillment center, it undergoes a meticulous Quality Check (QC) inspection. This inspection process takes between **24 to 48 business hours** from the time of arrival at the warehouse. Upon a successful verification outcome, a financial refund is triggered automatically.

Refund disbursements are processed based on the original payment channel selected during the transaction:

- **Credit/Debit Cards (Visa, Mastercard, American Express):** Refunds will reflect in your issuing bank account within **5 to 7 business days**, depending on your financial institution's processing cycles.
- **Net Banking & Direct Wire Transfers:** Funds will be credited to the source account within **3 to 5 banking days**.
- **Digital Wallets & Unified Payments Interface (UPI):** Reversals are typically visible within **24 to 48 hours** post-approval.
- **TechMart Store Credit (Instant Option):** Customers can opt to receive their refund in the form of TechMart Digital Store Credit. Store credit is generated instantly (within **1 hour** of QC approval) and remains valid for a period of 12 months for any future purchases on the platform.

Please note that initial shipping fees, priority handling charges, and cash-on-delivery (COD) convenience service fees are strictly non-refundable.

4. Item Exchange Policy and Stock Contingencies

TechMart provides a seamless exchange policy for customers who wish to replace an eligible item due to sizing discrepancies, color preferences, or model variations. An exchange request must be filed through the customer dashboard within the standard **15-day window**.

- **Eligibility:** Exchanges are strictly limited to products that are identical in value or belong to the same product family (e.g., swapping a garment size or a smartphone color variant). The item to be exchanged must meet all the pristine-condition criteria outlined in Section 1.
- **The Exchange Process:** Upon approval of your exchange request, TechMart will simultaneously dispatch the replacement item and schedule a reverse pickup for the original item.
- **Stock Outages & Contingencies:** In the event that your requested replacement item, size, or specific variant is out of stock or permanently discontinued, TechMart will automatically terminate the exchange ticket and issue a full financial refund to your original payment method, or credit your TechMart digital wallet, based on your stated preference.

5. Damaged, Defective, or Incorrect Item Resolution (In-Transit Incidents)

TechMart enforces an aggressive resolution protocol for items that arrive damaged, structurally defective, or materially different from what was ordered. Customers must report such incidents to our escalations team within **48 hours of delivery**. Failure to report within this strict 48-hour window will result in the claim being evaluated under standard warranty guidelines rather than an in-transit damage claim.

Mandatory Reporting Workflow:

1. **Documentation:** The customer must log into their TechMart account, navigate to the Resolution Center, and open a "Damaged/Defective Item Ticket."
2. **Visual Evidence:** You must upload 3 to 4 high-resolution photographs showing the external shipping box damage, the internal product packaging condition, and the specific physical defect or damage on the item itself. Providing an unedited unboxing video is highly recommended and significantly accelerates the validation process.
3. **Reverse Logistics:** Once the evidence is evaluated and verified by our customer triaging team, TechMart will schedule an expedited reverse pickup at zero cost to the customer.
4. **Final Resolution:** Upon arrival at our center, the item bypasses standard queues. TechMart will initiate an immediate, priority replacement shipment. If a replacement unit is unavailable, a full refund including initial shipping charges will be issued immediately.